

Polar bears can live in chilly Arctic regions because they are warm blooded and have thick fur.



Warm blood

Mammals are warm blooded, which means they can warm up and cool down their bodies to keep their temperature level. An elephant in the hot jungle is the same temperature as a polar bear in the snow.

Hairy beasts

All mammals are hairy – some are much hairier than others – and most have hair, often called fur, all over their bodies. They are hairy to keep them warm.

Elephant

This elephant may not look hairy but it does have hair on its body.

Polar bear

Getting around

Mammals are many different shapes that suit their lifestyles.



Cats: some mammals, such as the cat, have long legs to run with.



Bats: the bat is the only mammal that can fly – it has wings.



Dolphins: sea mammals have flippers and strong tails to swim with.



Moles: the mole has feet like spades, which are useful for burrowing.

The polar bear has thick fur all over its body.



The odd one out

It is usually true that animals give birth to live babies, but there are a few species, including this duck-billed platypus, that lay eggs. Platypus eggs are soft and the size of marbles.